UC Santa Barbara
Associated Students

Senate Agenda 5/21
Associated Students UCSB 76th Senate

Zoom Link

Minutes/Actions recorded by: Sydney Arbolado. **CALL TO ORDER** by Enri Lala, Internal Vice President **at 11:25PM.**
This meeting was called to order at 11:25 P.M. in the Loma Paloma by Internal Vice President Lala.

A) MEETING BUSINESS

"Before we begin, we call for students to acknowledge that the lands that the University of California locations were built upon were expropriated & founded upon exclusions and erasures of Indigenous people's human rights throughout California. UCSB is built on Chumash Land, specifically that of the non-federally recognized Barbareno tribe. As an association that pushes the student bodies' voices to the forefront, we should aim to make strides past just acknowledgment to those who continue to fight for their right to be recognized & respected as the original stewards of this land. I ask you all to dedicate time & care to personal education & to advocate for justice alongside Indigenous peoples."

A-1) Roll Call

Amna Chaudhry	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Caleb Claro	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	College of Letters & Sciences Senator
Mia Gutierrez	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	On-Campus Senator
Neo Harter	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Xander Hepburn	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Transfer Senator
Yuchang Jiang	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	International Senator

Melanie Jones	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	College of Letters & Sciences Senator
Noah Luken	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Victoria Ly	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Qhawe Manala	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	International Senator
Vanessa Manakova	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Nadine Malhis	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	On-Campus Senator
Olabisi Ola-Olaitan	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	University-Owned Off-Campus Senator
Keizo Ono	⛔ Absent	Off-Campus Senator
Suhrit Padakanti	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	College of Engineering Senator
Natalia Pascher	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Romi Riss	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Erica Sherkin	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Evan Sussman	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
Sohan Sunderrajan	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	College of Letters & Sciences Senator
Mira Than	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator
CJ Toledo	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	College of Letters & Sciences Senator
Jasmine Wang	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	On-Campus Senator
Eeman Wahidullah	✅ Present, ☀️ Early	Off-Campus Senator

A-2) Excused Absences

A-3) Acceptance of Proxies

B) External Reports

B-1) Chancellor's Representative-
B-2) UCPD Representative-
B-3) GSA Representative-
B-4) University Center Governance Board Representative-
B-5) IVCSD Representative-

C) New Business

D) PUBLIC FORUM
[1:30]

Speaking agreements:
"You have three minutes to speak, with three minutes for Q&A. Please state your name, pronouns, and enunciate, but refrain from yelling. Speculation of a Senator's intentions is prohibited and may result in you being removed from the ability to speak on the floor. Please know this meeting is being recorded. You may speak on any issue, whether it is on the agenda or not. Please include a content warning if it will be graphic. You may only come up once, and you may choose not to answer questions."

Ephraim Shalunov (11:28 PM to 11:32 PM)

- Thank you for giving me the privilege of being the first senator to address this body
- I know the feeling of excitement and apprehension
- First, wanted to read you some very old fashioned lines, George Washington's farewell address
- "All obstruction to the execution of the laws, all combinations and associations under what other plausible character with the real design to direct control and counteract or awe the regular deliberation and action of the constituted authorities, are destructive of this fundamental principle, and of fatal tendency. They serve to organize faction."
- Here to talk to you about the dangers of faction
- When Washington wrote it, we were threatened by a widening divide and new political parties
- Factions can be very dangerous, any size
- I beg and implore you that I have tried to overcome this divide
- To have a factional Senate and still a productive one
- It's impossible
- Please remember the people sitting next to you are just students, they had some vision, some story, for a better association and university

- AG Carlson and I will be sending you guys an invitation via email to hear our thoughts and reflections on our time in the association, attend if you can
- Good luck
- You've stepped up to a role that opens you to an infinite amount of criticism
- Congratulations

Wahidullah
- Thank you for coming here to support us and congratulate us
- Everyone is in full respect of your opinion
- We'll try our best to help everyone

Taylor Iden (11:33 PM to 11:35 PM)
- Wanted to echo Shalunov's sentiments
- Very hard year for everyone
- Stems from placing people in boxes and making assumptions
- Recommendation for you all is to throw you out the window
- Khorsandi, Amin, and Gerson, three people who I disagree vehemently with about politics
- But some of my closest friends I've found here
- Really easy to assume something about someone
- In a position to have great political discourse
- My recommendation is to be nice, talk to people, hear out opinions, disagree but don't take it out on the person
- I've been trying to do what I believe is best for the student body
- Micheal and Sean, I've grown closer with them this year, endless relationships that you can have with pro staff
- Shout out Fernando

Luken
- As a former senator will you make yourself available to us as senators if we have questions about whatever they may be in AS

Iden
- Yes, 100%
- You can assume whatever you want of me, don't have to understand why I made certain moves this year
- But use the resources available to you, email me
- Would love to hear from any of you

Lala
- Think we should limit it to one more person to public forum
- Want to say a few words on behalf of former Senator Shalunov
- I was not the only senator that wanted to write a resolution thanking you, for those of us who've interacted closely with you this last year, your contributions are frankly innumerable, endless

- Don't understand how someone a few weeks from graduation can still care so much about the community around him
- Appreciate you endlessly
- Will be introduced sometime this upcoming term

E) Acceptance of Agenda
Motion to accept the agenda.
Malhis - Luken
Call to question - Chaudhry
This motion passed at 11:48PM.

F) Consent Calendar-

G) Action Items

Standing Rules of the 76th ASUCSB Senate

Zha
- Essentially nothing changed much from the standing rules of the 75th Senate
- Those rules are in place to set clear expectations
- For instance, when do I send my legislation and expect it to be on the agenda next week
- How much discussion is allowed for it
- These expectations fall on the senators as well as Internal Vice President
- 3-time senator, now parliamentarian
- This is what I believe will best facilitate the deliberative discussion senate has and limit it to the agenda items
- And do not speculate the intention of other people, which has happened in every single past senate
- Feel free to give your input about the rules, great set of rules if I do say so

Lala
- Imperative that we have this
- Imperative that we have a draft approved today and then motions to modify it throughout the term
- Apologies for not sending it out earlier, slightly weird election season

Luken
- Want to echo chair's sentiments
- In the rules we're about to pass, can change them with a ⅔ vote very easily
- Important that we have these standing rules for future organization of meetings
- Concerns should be addressed
- Right now, in interest of time, and two, in interest of having a set of rules next meeting, I strongly recommend we pass these and move on

Motion to pass Standing Rules of the 76th ASUCSB Senate by a hand vote.
Wahidullah - Chaudhry
Call to question - Sussman

Hand Vote
Yes: 22
No: 0
Abstention: 0
This motion passed at 11:41PM.

Motion for the Senate to consider the extremely short transitional period following the AS 2025 Spring General Election and, with the consent of President Le Anh Metzger, extend the term of all BCU officers of the Association to the end of the 2025 Spring quarter, unless a replacement is nominated and approved for their position for the 2025-2026 school year.
Luken - Malhis
Call to question - Sussman
This motion passed at 11:42PM.

Motion to extend the term of 75th Senate Finance Committee members to the end of the 2025 Spring quarter for the purpose of updating AS Financial Policies and Procedures and facilitating financial functions.
Malhis - Luken
Call to question - Claro
This motion passed at 11:43PM.

G-2) Old Business
[Debate Time Per Item- 30 Minutes]

H) Recess

I-3) Unit Reports-
I-4) President's Cabinet Report-
I-5) Executive Director's Report-
I-6) Executive Officers' Report -
President Metzger's Report (11:43PM)

- Hello, will keep it short
- Congratulations on your election and appointments
- Honored and excited to serve you this school year
- Will be giving a longer address next week
- For now, working on transition meetings and filling my board

- Will be sending out an email for incoming board appointments tomorrow
- Thank you and I will see you all next week

Lala
- One thing to keep in mind, per the standing rules we just passed, executive officers and BCU representatives will have to be taking questions pertaining to the functions they reported on

Malhis
- Thank you president Metzger
- What are some things you expect the Senate to fulfill this year?

Metzger
- I'll be addressing all of that next week
- In the interest of time, it's almost midnight, don't want to keep you guys here too long

Lala
- Will keep this brief
- Want to echo the chair isn't supposed to give statements, but facilitate the function of the senate, giving myself this indulgence because I think it will facilitate the senate's function for the term
- Fully agree with the speaker before us that we have no reason to form faction
- The objectives are in front of us, don't need to list them all
- No need to recreate the dysfunction we've seen for years now, we can move past it

Sussman
- Would like to add something to new business
- Request from former senators to introduce senate resolution to commend Mingjun Zha's contributions

Lala
- Has this been motioned onto the agenda?

Luken
- Respectfully, to give former senator Zha the respect he deserves, we should do this next meeting so people can come up and congratulate him as he deserves

I-7) Senator Representative Reports-
I-8) Administrative Reports-
J) Committee Report
J-1) Standing Committee on Finance -
J-2) Standing Committee on Outreach -
J-3) Standing Committee on Liaison -

J-4) Standing Committee on Advocacy -
J-5) Group Project and other Temporary Committee Reports-

K) Minutes and Allocations:
To Be Approved

L) Discussion Items

M) Appointments

Parliamentarian:
MingJun Zha

Honoraria Committee:

Student Representatives-at-Large:

MingJun Zha
Eric Carlson
Roz Mirfenderski

Senator Representative:

Noah Luken

Motion to bundle and approve all appointments.
Malhis - Wahidullah
Call to question - Chaudhry
This motion passed at 11:27PM.

N) Remarks

O) Adjournment

Motion to adjourn the first meeting of the 76th Senate at 11:49 PM on Wednesday May 21st, 2025.
Luken - Toledo
Call to question - Chaudhry
This motion passed at 11:49PM.